

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Iran War Risk

Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible "false flag") and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE's own government and predating Aug 18; that "novel escalation vector" framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as "the first confirmed fatality" in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot ("at least 15"), and IMO's own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat "18th death" — that softened framing is carried everywhere below. A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp), then reviewed and COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail; see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (score set **2026-08-28_draft**) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29_draft) is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-08-22_draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 "Operation Economic Outcast" package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman's own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-31_draft) is a light daily catch-up** covering the Aug 29-31 gap: on Aug 30, US forces struck IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Iran's Larak Island — the first US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29 — directly firing this pillar's own pre-declared flip line ("a

resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper"). Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles on two US-linked Jordan airbases hours later; Jordan intercepted 8 missiles; no confirmed US casualty. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76), front-loaded and held under 8 points per window. This is a light daily touch, not a full weekly refresh, no window moved >8 points, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip vs. the last stamped set — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-01_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — a THIRD Hormuz tanker hit (the VLCC Senegal Prosperity, Aug 31), a disputed Iranian claim of a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base (UAE MoD denies the target claim but confirms it intercepted an Iranian drone over its waters), and Trump on-record Aug 31 still weighing further strikes on Iran. **P RE-RATED DOWN again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — no window moved more than 2 points, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority** — the new last COMMITTED baseline. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-02_draft) is a further light daily catch-up that turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since Aug 30:** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a new "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan (4+ dead per the Hormozgan governor's office, including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — flagged here as SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level (Iranian state/local authorities; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it), so it does not by itself move P, but it is the reported trigger for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile/drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — larger in scale than the single-state Aug 30-31 Jordan strike, but all four are repeat targets, so the "widening to a further NEW state" flip-line clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN sharply to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75), front-loaded and kept under 8 points per window. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026,** retroactively, under Alex's Sept 3 widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer disqualifying on their own. The wedding-casualty fact was correctly kept single-narrative-sourced and never used to move P, and nothing about the sourcing or the research itself changed — only the stamping threshold did. This remains the last TRUE committed baseline: 1/9/27/47/74. **Sept 3:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Kuwait and UAE — both repeat targets, no US-manned facility hit, widening clause does not fire. **P HELD FLAT. Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft):** held flat again — the Reuters weapons-expert corroboration of the Sept 1 wedding strike resolves attribution of an already-priced event, not new escalation; a Sept 5 Iranian-media report of a US strike on the tanker STARK 1 near Kharg Island is single-narrative and not used to move P. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here, not corrected retroactively. **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — the STARK 1 incident is real and developing (Iran International separately obtained video of US radio warnings, and AP itself frames it as an Iranian accusation, not a confirmed fact) but CENTCOM has still not confirmed or denied it, so per the sufficiency rule it is NOT used to move P. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week. **HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft):** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this report had withheld pending confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known: THREE Iranian tankers (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) struck in retaliation for an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships, both of which evaded. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** — no window moved more than 2 points, no flip-line clause independently fires (no confirmed US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent short of \$100), and the master call band held Neutral → Neutral. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-08_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 6-8: the new fact is Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record Sept 6-7 announcement (state TV, Press TV, Tehran Times) that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, GlobalSecurity.org) but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed ("further details... yet to be announced" per Al Jazeera's Sept 7 explainer). No flip-line clause fires (DCAS still 18, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, no new state). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-09_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 8-9: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org); both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC News; ~\$100.44, +2.57%) — a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause, but it is the

closest this cycle has come to the flip line. No flip-line clause fires (no US casualty, no new state, only an intraday Brent cross). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-10_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 9-10: two new dated facts. CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base — 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org, Jordan's own military). Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening clause does not fire, and both sides confirm no casualties, so the US-casualty clause does not fire either. Separately, Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, SCMP, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), but the same Houthi/Yemen actor already priced, and no strait closure has actually been executed, so this does not independently fire a clause either. Brent has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Sept 9; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but still short of a clean sustained-close call. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". See My Decision below.

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified September 11, 2026 — light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-11_draft (P re-rated down modestly to 1/4/20/40/71; the "sustained Brent close above \$100" third straight session — Brent closed above \$107 Thursday Sept 10, its highest since May 19 — alongside fuller reporting of Iran's 10-vessel Sept 9 shipping wave) · COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPT committed: Sept 10 (2026-09-10_draft), auto-stamped · Not Financial Advice

end column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Aug 8 (cut to 1mo/3mo, full weekly refresh) committed and stamped by Alex · Aug 9-16 are light daily touches, all held flat (no cycle ran Aug 15) · Aug 17-21 drafted but never delivered
 research passes plus two dedicated adversarial passes, cut to 14/22/38/54/76, HELD FLAT vs. the morning draft) was left as a draft at delivery (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from auto-stamp) and **COMMITTED BY ALEX**
 catch-up draft P flat but was never rendered/selfchecked/archived/committed — abandoned/superseded. An Aug 29 full weekly refresh independently re-researched the week and also HELD P flat at 14/22/38/54/76, left as a
 categorically excluded from auto-stamp) pending Alex's manual review — that draft is now superseded and collapses out of this table per house rules on committed sets. **Aug 31 (2026-08-31_draft)** was a light daily catch-up covered
 strike on Iranian territory (Larak Island, Aug 30) plus an Iranian retaliatory strike on two US-linked Jordan airbases fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line — P cut to 9/17/34/51/75, **AUTO-STAMPED**. **Sept 1 (2026-09-01_draft)**
 catch-up covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — P cut again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75, **AUTO-STAMPED**, the last COMMITTED set. **This section (score set 2026-09-02_draft) covers Sept 1-2:**
 CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran (~50x the scale of the Aug 30 strike), including the war's first direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers; a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Hormuz
 scored directly); Iran's IIRC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — all repeat targets, so the widening clause does not fire). **P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/4**
 points per window. Originally left as draft Sept 2 pending Alex's manual review (single-narrative core fact, genuinely novel scale, both sides threatening larger future action, and the master call band flip Mild Bull → Neutral); **COMMITTED BY ALEX**
SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy so a call-band flip and move size no longer withhold the stamp on their own — this is the last TRUE committed set. **Sept 3** — Iran's second retaliatory war
 targets; P HELD FLAT. **Sept 5 (2026-09-05_draft)** held flat again; that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status was never actually advanced — flagged as a correction, not itself edited. **Sept 5**
05_draft2, this version) independently re-verifies via WebSearch, including the Sept 5 STARK 1/Kharg Island tanker report (still unconfirmed by CENTCOM, not used to move P); categorically excluded from daily auto-stamp authority
COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft) re-rates P down modestly to 1/8/25/45/73 once CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike as a 3-tanker
 on 2 US Navy warships — no window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral); **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new committed baseline. **Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft)**
 down modestly again to 1/7/24/44/73 on Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's Sept 6-7 announcement of intent to declare a restricted zone beyond Hormuz into the Persian Gulf — a genuine new escalatory signal, corroborated by
 intent, not yet executed — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral); **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the committed baseline. **Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft)**
 rates P down modestly again to 1/6/23/43/72: CENTCOM's own press release confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) after the IIRC fired
 ballistic missiles twice — corroborated by 5+ independent outlets — and Brent crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24, a single-day cross short of this pillar's sustained-\$100 flip line. No window moved more
 unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft)** re-rates P down modestly again to 1/5/22/42/70
 Jordan's Al Azraq air base in retaliation for the Sept 8 tanker strike (18 intercepted, no casualties), and Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second chokepoint, but
 Brent traded above \$100 for a second straight session, still short of a sustained close. No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.
 Decision below.

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/22 (COMMITTED)	8/31 (COMMITTED)	9/1 (COMMITTED)	9/2 (COMMITTED)	9/5 D2 (COMMITTED)	9/6 (COMMITTED)	9/8 (COMMITTED)	9/9	9/10	9/11 (COMMITTED)	QUAL.
1 month	50	...	14	9	7	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	0.60
3 months	55	...	22	17	15	9	9	8	7	6	5	4	0.65
6 months	62	...	38	34	32	27	27	25	24	23	22	20	0.70
1 year	75	...	54	51	50	47	47	45	44	43	42	40	0.65
3 years	85	...	76	75	75	74	74	73	73	72	72	71	0.55

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. **THIS CYCLE (Sept 11, score set 2026-09-11_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from the Sept 10-committed 1/5/22/42/72). **second, distinct flip-line clause fires.** This pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause, which the Sept 9 intraday cross and the Sept 10 second session came close to but did not cross in the first consecutive session: Brent **ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107** after trading above \$108 intraday — its highest in nearly four months, since May 19 — with WTI closing a record high since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the eve of the *Correction to the prior cycle*: that cycle, run mid-morning Sept 10, logged Brent at ~\$101.25 "Thursday Sept 10" — an intraday read; Thursday's actual close was far higher, above \$107. **BEARISH** — fuller reporting of the Sept 9 shipping wave — Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz, 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers, the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the 2011 Gulf of Aden seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill — 4 independent). A merchant seafarer is *not* a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not strike on a further new state was confirmed, so the widening clause does not fire either. **Logged but NOT used to move P (single-source):** a compilation putting Hormuz throughput at 7.7 mb/d, a 10-day average of 10-13 commodity vessels/day. **Counterweight, also logged:** Friday's give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around Hormuz plus the IEA's 2.5 mb/d 2026 demand-constraint.

market is not pricing monotonic escalation. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 5→4, 6mo 22→20, 12mo 42→40, 36mo 72→71.** A clause of this pillar's own flip line fire evidence standard — but under the runbook's widened delegated authority the size of a move is not itself a reason to withhold the stamp; the sourcing clears the primary-plus-multi-outlet bar, so **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior cycle (Sept 10, score set 2026-09-10_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72 (from the Sept 9-committed 1/6/23/43/72). Two new dated facts. **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base** — Jordan's armed forces say 18 were intercepted, 2 fell in unconfirmed casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause is not used. And Jordan both confirm no casualties, so the confirmed-US-casualty clause also does NOT fire (DCAS remains 18, unchanged since Sept 4 — a separate low-quality aggregator claiming a fresh confirmed US casualty is rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own no-casualties statement). **BEARISH and NEW: Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, Bab el-Mandeb Strait** — a SECOND global shipping chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Cyprus Mail), clearing the sufficiency bar. This is the same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already priced, not a strike on a further new state, and no strait closure or shipping interdiction has been confirmed. Outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on" and "threatening" control, not as having executed a blockade — so it does not independently fire a flip-line clause either. Separately, Brent crude has closed \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's single-session short of a clean multi-session "sustained" call by this pillar's own conservative standard; flagged as the closest this cycle has come to the flip line and worth close watching next cycle, but it does not clear the sufficiency bar. Net: a repeat-pattern regional strike plus a new-but-same-actor Yemen/Red Sea territorial escalation, both intensifying the trend already priced without crossing any flip-line threshold. **RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 6→5, 6mo 23→22, 12mo 43→42, 36mo held at 72** (a repeat regional strike and a same-theater territorial shift do not move the multi-year thesis). Sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull → Mild Bull horizontal). Per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 9, score set 2026-09-09_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72 (from the Sept 8-committed 1/7/24/44/73). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM confirmed 5 IRGC Tankers Afer Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days.** Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own release — clears the sufficiency bar. CENTCOM confirms both Iranian missile attempts were evaded and no US personnel were harmed. Confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired — and this is a repeat pattern (Gulf of Oman, Kharg Island are both existing theater), not a widening to a further new state. Separately, Brent crude closed intraday today (Sept 9) for the first time since July 24 — confirmed by CNBC ("Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries") and ABC News, trading ~\$100.44, clearing the day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause either; flagged as the closest this cycle has come to the flip line. Separately, "restricted zone" announcement (already logged in the Sept 8 baseline as a not-yet-executed escalation) remains in the same state — coverage today still describes boundaries as unspecified/forthcoming. The cut is scored a second time. This is a continuation/intensification of the same escalation trend the Sept 6/8 cycles already priced, not a fresh flip-line event, sized consistently with those cycles' moderate escalation. **RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 7→6, 6mo 24→23, 12mo 44→43, 36mo 73→72.** This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 8, score set 2026-09-08_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73 (from the Sept 6-committed 1/8/25/45/73). **BEARISH and NEW: Iran's SNSI announced on-record (Iranian state TV, carried by Press TV and Tehran Times) that Iran will declare, "in the coming days," a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade of the Persian Gulf, with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list.** He separately said an Iran-Oman corridor agreement would be signed "in the coming days." This is corroborated by (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) reporting the same on-record statement — clearing the sufficiency bar. It is a genuine new escalation. CENTCOM's THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced," and no zone had actually been declared. Research cutoff. Consistent with this pillar's past treatment of confirmed-but-not-yet-executed escalatory statements (e.g. Trump's Aug 31 "still weighing further strikes" comment), this is sized as a moderate escalation cut, not a flip-line event: DCAS US KIA remains 18 (unchanged since Sept 4), no widening to a further new state, and Brent closed ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 (tradingeconomics.com) — still short of the flip threshold. GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) blockade count of 92 vessels redirected / 3 disabled / 2 boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced blockade. The cut is not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed (still "in the coming days" per Rezaei; the existing temporary 7-mile corridor from late August remains the operational baseline). **RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 8→7, 6mo 25→24, 12mo 45→44, 36mo held at 73** (a shipping-zone threat doesn't move the multi-year thesis). This cycle's window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 6 light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-06_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73 (from the Sept 5-committed 1/9/27/47/74). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM Sept 5 tanker strike this report withheld from moving P is now CENTCOM-confirmed, and is more serious than known.** CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil, corroborated by Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets) states US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers on Sept 5 — M/T Downy (permanently disabled off Kharg Island), M/T St. Johns (disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer) in multiple attacks, no American personnel were harmed. Admiral Brad Cooper, CENTCOM's commander: "If you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking the cut clears the sufficiency bar the Sept 5 baseline explicitly withheld on (it had only Iran's Tasnim state-media claim, with AP framing it as an accusation and CENTCOM silent) — it is now primary-source confirmed, and it reveals a materially more serious escalation than a quiet single-tanker interdiction: a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels. Separately, Sept 6 (today) confirmed three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone in the Strait of Hormuz (Al Jazeera's live blog, Euronews) are IRGC's own claims only — not yet US-confirmed, so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, NOT independently used to move P; watch next cycle. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: no confirmed new US combat death (DCAS still 18 as of Sept 4, unchanged from Sept 3), no widening to a further new state (Kharg Island, Jask, and the Gulf of Oman are all existing theater), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 (US/UK markets closed Saturday) — still short of the flip line. The cut is sized as a confirmed-escalation/severity-upgrade to an already-known event, not a fresh flip-line shock, and kept small: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -3, 36mo -4. This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral). Per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle: P was RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74 (Sept 2, committed Sept 3, then HELD FLAT through Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE repeat-target strikes and the Sept 5 full weekly update, and Scores section above for that flat-hold history) (from the Sept 1-committed 7/15/32/50/75) — researched Sept 2, **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** under Alex's widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy. **BEARISH and CONFIRMED, the load-bearing new fact: the conflict escalated materially Sept 1-2, confirming exactly the risk this pillar's own Sept 1 note flagged.** CENTCOM confirmed 100 targets across Iran Sept 1-2 — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, communications sites, and anti-ship cruise-missile/drone launchers — roughly 50x the scale of the single-source claim (multi-source: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI). For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved escalation. A marked shift from the prior posture of intercepting attacks. Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1 — its best session in 5 weeks — to ~\$95.96/bbl, WTI to ~\$91.92, still short of the \$100 flip line. A confirmed US casualty (Hormozgan, near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party: the Hormozgan governor's office named 4 of at least 5 dead, including a 4-year-old, plus 60+ injured (Al Jazeera, CBS News). **EXPLICITLY AS SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level:** the casualty claim originates with Iranian state and local authorities, and CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the claim was confirmed nor denied it — so per the sufficiency rule, this claim alone does not move P, even though multiple Western outlets report the claim (wide pickup of a single-narrative core fact is not the fact itself). It is reported here as context for what it triggered: Iran's IRGC launched coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 at US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously: Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — a materially larger, four-country retaliation versus the single-state Jordan strike Aug 30-31. But all four are REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28 and Aug 30; Iraq: struck at various points since Feb-Jul 2026 per this war's own tracker pages), so the pillar's own "widening to a FURTHER NEW state with confirmed attribution" flip-line clause does NOT fire. No confirmed US casualties intercepted (Jordan: roughly 10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed with no reported casualties; Bahrain: most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted), and no confirmed new US combat death has been reported. So neither the casualty clause nor the widening clause independently fires either. The already-fired (Aug 30) "resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" clause is simply continuing and escalating. P moves further down this cycle. Both sides are now on-record threatening larger future action: President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed Iranian source told press Tehran's response would be "many times greater" (CNBC) — read as continued war-escalation risk, not de-escalation. The cut is front-loaded and kept under the 8-point/widening threshold. **RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74. Originally left as draft Sept 2, not auto-stamped, for three reasons:** (1) the wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political resonance of a country retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced even though widely reported, so confidence in today's sizing was lower than for a clearly multi-sourced primary event; (2) the scale jump (near direct tanker strikes) is a genuinely novel escalation beyond this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedent; (3) both sides' on-record threats of much larger responses ahead raised the cost of escalation. The cut independently flipped the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus the last stamped set, which under the then-current rules disqualified auto-stamp on its own. **Alex reviewed this cycle and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and move size are no longer disqualifying by themselves.** The underlying sourcing and the cut itself are unchanged — the wedding-casualty claim still was not used to move P — only the stamping threshold changed. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026.** See My Decision below.

Prior to this cycle (Sept 1 light daily catch-up): P was RE-RATED DOWN to 7/15/32/50/75 (from the Aug 31-committed 9/17/34/51/75) — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. **BEARISH load-bearing new fact then: escalation continued into a second day.** The Aug 30-31 cut (see below) was explicitly sized on the assumption that "one resumed-strike night is not yet a sustained escalation" — an assumption is undercut by what happened next. A THIRD Hormuz tanker was hit Aug 31: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity, struck by three unknown projectiles ~17 nautical miles during outbound transit — hit on the port side, engine room, and ballast tank; no casualties, no environmental impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetia (Aug 25) incidents. Iran's army (not IRGC) claimed a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base near Dubai; the UAE Ministry of Defense explicitly DENIED that Al Minhad was targeted, while the US Navy force intercepted an Iranian drone detected over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iran — a disputed target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone incursion, a genuine (if unconfirmed) widening beyond the repeat-target Jordan pattern. Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31, but as a repeat target (already struck Jul 28), not a "further new" state per this pillar's own framing. President Trump Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicitly not signaling de-escalation. Brent crude (a ~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports) on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight cycle of gains on this news thread. No new confirmed confirmed hit on UAE territory (UAE denies), so this does NOT independently fire a fresh flip-line clause on its own — neither the "confirmed new US combat death" clause nor a clean "further escalation" clause. This is a continuation/erosion of the "single incident" framing, not a fresh shock of comparable size to the Aug 30-31 cut itself — hence the small move, well under the 8-point auto-strike line (3mo 17→15, 6mo 34→32, 12mo 51→50, 36mo 75→75 flat). Corroborated across CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, Iran International, and US 30 US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island in the Strait of Hormuz after observing preparations to fire sea mines into the strait — CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Linder Aug 30 record, corroborated by 20+ independent outlets (Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, etc.) was the first acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-consecutive-clean-night streak the Aug 29 baseline explicitly cited as part of its bullish case, and it directly declared downside flip line ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken") — not a novel judgment call, a pre-committed trigger firing exactly as written. US soldiers/civilians killed or wounded at Larak (no precise toll given) and retaliated hours later, into Aug 31, with ballistic missiles at two US-linked airbases in Jordan (King Hussein, Al-Azraq); Jordan intercepted 8 missiles, and Iran claims "heavy damage" to base infrastructure — unconfirmed by the US or Jordan beyond the interception, so logged as Iran-sourced, not scored as fact. That was a ~10-point move under 8 points per window, sized similarly to the Jul 28 Jordan-strike precedent for a comparable single-incident shock: 1mo 14→9, 3mo 22→17, 6mo 38→34, 12mo 54→51 and 36mo 76→75. The Aug 30-31 weekly refresh had held P flat at 14/22/38/54/76 on a genuinely two-sided ledger: **BEARISH and CONFIRMED: the "Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24.** Directly fettered by the US Treasury press release sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and sb0614 (Bessent's remarks), plus an OFAC recent-actions entry dated 2024-08-24, plus the state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels were designated across the Middle East: Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five sectoral determinations (EO 13902). Critically, this is the FIRST TIME digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector under this pillar's framework, with addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and TRON were listed. Unlike the sanctions this pillar tracked in prior cycles as "promised but not landed" (Bessent's rhetoric through Aug 22), this is real, per the pillar's directly crypto-relevant — a genuine escalation. It continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation. Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents fired this window: Aug 26 (no damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire, extinguished, crew safe, UKMTO) — both comparable in severity to the already-established pattern. CENTCOM commander Adm. Michael G. Smith Aug 28 briefing (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iranian sea mines from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~100 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed — read as confirmation of an existing posture, not a new shock. IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 deaths of the previously-reported 15-19 range, a slight negative confirmation, not a new shock. **BULLISH and CONFIRMED: Oman's own Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a Hormuz corridor, Aug 28.** The pillar's fm.gov.om/en/53722 (Oman's own government site) — a genuine upgrade, because in every prior cycle only Iran claimed a Hormuz deal and Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry confirmed it. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor per the pillar's framework. Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were disclosed in the pillar's framework. The IRGC spokesman claim (Aug 26) of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal remains single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded from scoring, same treatment as prior single-source claims. The Strait "demined" with a zero-tolerance policy on new mines Aug 25 (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack above. The first quantified increase of the entire crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-primary shipping data, 2 independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 22) vs. prior week (westbound 29→42); still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but the first confirmed uptick of the whole crisis. Brent eased for a SECURITIZATION (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further away from the \$100/bbl flip line, with press explicitly framing the "unwinding" on the Hormuz progress. No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29 (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, a standing casualty total, not a new event) — the flip line remains unfired. No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th confirmed confirmed strike. **Net assessment: the new escalation and the new de-escalation roughly offset.** The pillar's own explicit upside flip line — a signed, US-accepted Hormuz deal holding a full attack/fatality seizure — is NOT met, since the Aug 27 attack breaks the "clean week" clause and the corridor deal remains Iran+Oman only (not US-accepted). Consistent with this pillar's stance, the single-cycle mixed signals in either direction: P HELD FLAT on all five windows.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle's load-bearing fact — Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record restricted-zone announcement — is corroborated across 8+ independent sources (The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org, Tehran Times) reporting the same statement, well above the sufficiency bar, though it is explicitly a statement of intent, not an act — a distinction reflected in sizing the cut small, not in the Quality input itself. Quality (the 0-1 input) is unchanged this cycle per house rules: 0.60/0.65/0.70/0.65/0.55 for 1/3/6/12/36mo.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC traded at \$77,063 on Sept 11, down from \$77,993.99 on Sept 10 and \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 (local run.py quant) — the tape fell again as this pillar's own evidence also moved further negative (the sustained Brent break above \$100, the 10-vessel Sept 9 shipping wave); per house discipline the tape was adjusted to chase or match the tape either way, and the two moving in the same direction this cycle is not treated as confirmation. For context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from \$77,000.00, a real, visible risk-off pullback logged when this pillar's evidence last moved sharply negative.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 11, 2026 (re-checked Sept 11, P re-rated down modestly as the "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause finally fires)

This cycle (Sept 11): the crowd will read a \$108 print and a 6% up-day in Brent as the war finally repricing energy — or, watching Friday's 3% give-back on Hormuz diplomacy headlines, wave the flag and think the level matters less than the fact that this pillar wrote down a specific, falsifiable clause — a *sustained* Brent close above \$100 — and three consecutive sessions above it, including a close above \$100 and a near-miss. I said so in the two prior cycles when it hadn't fired yet; the discipline only counts if it also fires when the number arrives. What it does *not* do is change what the war is: still no confirmed confirmed confirmed no strike on a further new state, and the one death in the Sept 9 shipping wave was a merchant seafarer, not a service member. So this is a further modest cut, not a regime change — and the headlines are logged honestly alongside it.

Prior cycle (Sept 10): the crowd is likely to either read the Al Azraq missile barrage as a dangerous new peak of the conflict, or wave off a Yemeni port city changing hands as background noise to the war in the Gulf — both miss the point. **Me:** 20 ballistic missiles at a US-linked airbase sounds large in isolation, but Jordan has now absorbed this kind of strike repeatedly since Jul 28, and both CENTCOM and the US confirm no casualties this time either — a repeat-pattern event, not a new category. The Houthi seizure of Mocha is more interesting precisely because it's easy to dismiss: it's the same actor this pillar's framework has priced in since the Sea/Bab al-Mandeb theater for months, so it doesn't independently widen the war, but "closing in on" a second global chokepoint is a genuine structural development worth flagging even though it was executed yet. Brent trading above \$100 for a second straight session is the more important tell than either strike — not yet a sustained close, but the clearest signal yet that markets are pricing the war as a day spike. Re-rating down modestly again (1/5/22/42/72, from 1/6/23/43/72), consistent with the sizing this pillar has used for every cycle since Sept 6.

Prior cycle (Sept 9): the crowd is likely to either read Brent's intraday \$100 cross as confirmation the flip line has effectively fired, or dismiss the 5-tanker CENTCOM strike as "more of the same" and miss the point. **Me:** Brent trading above \$100 for part of one session is a real data point and the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but it is explicitly not the same thing as a sustained close above \$100. The pillar's own pre-declared threshold requires — so it does not independently fire that clause, though it earns a mention in every relevant section below rather than being quietly dropped. The CENTCOM strike is a larger single incident than the 3-tanker strike this pillar priced on Sept 6, but it is the same repeat pattern (Gulf of Oman, Kharg Island) responding to the same kind of provocation (an IRGC naval attack on a warship) — a continuation of an already-priced trajectory, not a new category of event, so I am re-rating down modestly again (1/6/23/43/72, from 1/7/24/44/73) rather than sharply, consistent with the pillar's framework.

Prior cycle (Sept 8): the crowd is likely to either dismiss Rezaei's restricted-zone announcement as Iran "talking tough" without follow-through, or treat it as an imminent full closure of a new strategic front in opposite directions. **Me:** a declared intent to sanction shipping across an expanded zone is a real escalatory signal worth logging and worth a small cut, but it is not yet an executed act — no breach of the mechanism, and no confirmed incident tied to it as of this cycle's research cutoff. Re-rating down modestly (1/7/24/44/73, from 1/8/25/45/73) rather than sharply, because none of this pillar's flip-line clauses fired, no new state, Brent short of \$100 and it is consistent with — not a departure from — this pillar's past treatment of announced-but-unexecuted escalatory statements. I am explicitly not re-rating down this pillar's framework, that an Iran-Oman corridor deal will also be signed "in the coming days" as bullish either — until it is actually signed, it's the same "very close" pattern this pillar has discounted for weeks.

Prior cycle (Sept 6): the crowd was likely to read CENTCOM's own confirmation of the Sept 5 tanker strike as a relief ("finally, official clarity") rather than what it actually was — a confirmation that the strike was real, not the unconfirmed version: not a quiet single-tanker interdiction, but an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships that the US answered by destroying three tankers. R (1/8/25/45/73, from 1/9/27/47/74) rather than sharply, because none of this pillar's flip-line clauses fired on it (no US casualty, no new state, Brent short of \$100) and the escalation — while more severe — was still a continuation of the same "resumption of direct US strikes" trajectory already priced in since Aug 30, not a new category of event. Sept 6's separate IRGC claims of further tanker/vessel/air strikes were used to move P — those are Iran's own claims, unconfirmed by the US, and the sufficiency rule is exactly what stops a claim like that from doing more work than it's earned.

The crowd: is likely to anchor on the wedding-strike casualty claim as the emotional center of today's news, and either (a) treat it as a confirmed atrocity driving the story, or (b) dismiss the whole thing as propaganda because that one claim is single-sourced — both are wrong. The scale of the underlying US strike wave (nearly 100 targets, first-ever direct tanker strikes) is independently, multi-sourced, and the casualty dispute resolves, and is the real story this cycle.

Me: cutting sharply to 1/9/27/47/74, versus the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped). This is the largest single-cycle P move this pillar has made since the Aug 30-31 flip-line-firing cut, and then, **I am NOT auto-stamping it** — I'm leaving it as a draft and flagging it prominently for Alex's manual review. Three reasons, stated plainly: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the political four-country Iranian retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced at the level that matters (Iranian state/local authorities, CENTCOM neither confirming nor denying), even though it's widely reported; (2) lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event, and I don't want to self-approve a cut this large resting partly on that; (3) the scale jump — ~50x the Aug 30 strike, plus the war's first direct escalation — novel escalation this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents (Jul 28 Jordan, Aug 30 Larak) don't cleanly cover, and sizing a cut for a genuinely new magnitude of event is exactly the kind of thing that shouldn't be quietly self-approved; (3) both sides are now on-record threatening much larger responses ahead — a miscalibrated cut here is more costly than usual given what could follow. That's why I bounded, not panic-sized: kept under 8 points per window, and the four-country retaliation does NOT independently fire the widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause because all four targets are confirmed.

My edge: the discipline here is refusing to let a single-source emotional fact do more work than it's earned, in either direction — not discarding it (it's genuinely the trigger for today's retaliation) and not letting it silently inflate the cut beyond what the independently-confirmed facts (strike count, tanker strikes, four-country retaliation, mutual escalation threats) support on their own. The crowd reacts to a claim like this; this pillar tries to size around it instead.

Honesty check against the tape: BTC fell from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp) to \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own sharp move. Under the system's own discipline, this pillar's score is **not** adjusted to chase or match BTC's move — it scores evidence, not price action — but the comparison itself is logged here explicitly as an honesty check.

The Facts

As of September 11, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This is a light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft) vs the Sept 10 committed baseline; this cycle's findings appear first, then facts carried forward from prior cycles (still load-bearing).

- ★ ★ **NEW — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107, after trading above \$108 intraday — its highest close above \$102 for the first time since May.** Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent). Three consecutive sessions above \$100, two of them confirmed closes and one decisively so. *Correction:* the prior cycle, run mid-morning Sept 10, Sept 10" — that was an intraday read, not the close.
- ★ ★ **NEW — fuller reporting of the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks since the war began.** At least one seafarer was killed and another listed missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill — 4 independent). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member; a combat-death clause does NOT fire.
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** a compilation of Hormuz transit data puts throughput at 7 transits on Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day moving average of 10-13 commodity vessels per day, directionally consistent with the strike wave; a single compilation cannot move a P under the house sufficiency rule.
- **Counterweight, logged:** Friday Sept 11's ~3% Brent give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around the Strait of Hormuz and to the IEA's forecast of a 2.5 mb/d contraction in 2026 demand — the market is not pricing monotonic escalation, and this report does not either.
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, in retaliation for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** 18 were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement) — clears the sufficiency bar. Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does not fire.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait,** a SECOND global shipping chokepoint confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail). Same actor/theater already priced; no strait closure confirmed — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on," not as having executed a blockade.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session,** more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9, TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — the closest this cycle has come to this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause, but still short of a clean multi-session sustained call.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state and no confirmed US casualty:** Jordan is a repeat target, and CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties from the Al Azraq strike; DCAS remains silent (a low-quality aggregator's claim of a fresh KIA figure was checked and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own statement).
- **BTC traded at \$77,063 on Sept 11** — down from \$77,993.99 on Sept 10 and \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 (local full quant refresh this cycle, run.py quant).

Carried forward from Sept 9 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Dabul.** IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days. Corroborated across 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org, CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship")) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24,** trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC "Brent crude tops \$100 as US supply worries," ABC News) — a single-day intraday cross, not a sustained close, so it does not independently fire this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line clause; the closest this cycle has come to that.
- **NEW — both Iranian missile attempts on the US Navy warship were evaded, no US personnel harmed** — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state:** Gulf of Oman and Kharg Island are both existing theater already struck in this war.
- **Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains not-yet-executed** — no new dated development, not re-scored a second time.
- **BTC traded at \$79,052.40 on Sept 9** — up from \$78,435.62 on Sept 8 and \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 8 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beyond the Strait of Hormuz "in the coming days."** The zone would extend the blockade line and extend into parts of the Persian Gulf; any vessel entering it would be placed on Iran's sanctions list. Corroborated across 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Arab News, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media (Press TV, Tehran Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced." Rezaei separately said an agreement would be signed "in the coming days" — also not yet done as of this research pass.
- **GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) tracker puts the blockade count at 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded** — up from Day 190's 87/3/2 (Sept 3), a continuation of the already-priced trend, not scored separately.
- **BTC traded at \$78,435.62 on Sept 8** — down from \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 and \$80,338.98 on Sept 6 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 6 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5, resolving the tanker report this pillar had withheld previously.** Downy (permanently disabled off Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at US Navy warships.

warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of which evaded multiple attacks with no American personnel harmed. Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NB outlets, in addition to CENTCOM's own release.

- ★ **This revealed a materially more serious escalation than the Sept 5 baseline knew:** not a quiet single-tanker interdiction, but a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels and retaliation. Adm. Brad Cooper (CENTCOM commander): "If you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost — taking out three of yours."
- **Sept 6's IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remain US-unconfirmed as of this cycle.
- **BTC traded at \$79,929.30 on Sept 6** — up from \$79,646.11 on Sept 5 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 2 (re-verified through the Sept 5 full weekly refresh and this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ **CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak Island strike.** Targets included IRGC air-defense sites, radar installations, communications sites, and anti-ship cruise-missile and drone launchers. Multi-source corroborated: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy** — posture of intercepting Iranian attacks on third-party shipping to direct strikes on Iranian state vessels.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1, its best session in 5 weeks, to ~\$95-96.6/bbl; WTI to ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ ★ **NEW, FLAGGED SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED — a US strike on Kuestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party.** The Hormozgan governor's office including a 4-year-old, plus 60+ injured (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI report the claim). CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it. The claim along with Iranian state/local authorities — wide Western-outlet pickup of that one narrative is not the same as independent multi-sourcing of the underlying fact. Per the sufficiency rule, this claim alone is as context for the retaliation it triggered.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait** — simultaneous retaliation versus the single-state Jordan strike Aug 30-31 — but all four are REPEAT targets already struck earlier in this war (Jordan: Jul 28, Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck earlier) so the "widening to a FURTHER NEW state with confirmed attribution" flip-line clause does NOT fire.
- **NEW — most projectiles were intercepted:** Jordan (~10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed, no reported casualties); Bahrain (most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted). No confirmed new US deaths — run — neither the "confirmed new US combat death" clause nor the widening clause independently fires.
- **NEW — both sides now on-record threatening larger future action:** President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military official said a response would be "many times greater" (CNBC) — read as continued escalation risk, not de-escalation.
- **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles off Khasab, Oman, during outbound transit — hit on the port side, engine room, and ballast tank. No casualties, no environmental impact reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-reported Aug 25 incidents — the third such hit in the same window.
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES that base was targeted while CONFIRMING a separate cross-border drone strike on its waters, approaching from Iran.** So: a disputed target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone incursion — reported via CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Reuters, International.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran,** calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicitly not a "new" escalation.
- **Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports)** on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight cycle of escalation.
- **Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31,** but remained a repeat, not a "further new," state per this pillar's own framing (already struck Jul 28 and again as part of the Aug 30 IRGC retaliation) — no widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause.
- **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers off Hormuz after observing preparations to fire sea mines into the strait — Capt. Tim Hawkins (CENTCOM) confirmed on the record; corroborated by Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, New York Times, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, India TV, and Time. The first acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-consecutive-day period of no direct strikes. **US forces fired this pillar's own pre-declared flip line** ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement plus multi-source reporting.** IRGC said it struck two airbases in response to the Larak strike; Jordan's military said it intercepted 8 missiles; Iran claims "heavy damage" to base infrastructure, unconfirmed by the US or Jordan beyond the intercepted missiles. Not scored as fact. IRGC separately confirmed Iranian soldiers/civilians killed or wounded at Larak (no precise toll given).
- **Press (Reuters/CNBC) framed the renewed exchange as weighing on Asian equities and US futures,** reversing the prior two-week Brent decline.
- **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 on Aug 31** — up from \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov.** Press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iran's Oil and Gas Sector") and sb0614 (Bessent's remarks), plus an OFAC recent-actions entry dated 20260824 — corroborated by state.gov and 3+ independent trade-compliance/crypto-intelligence outlets (The Heritage Foundation, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated across Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations. **Iran's digital assets was explicitly named as a sanctionable sector** — 30 crypto addresses across Bitcoin, Ethereum, and TRON were listed. Unlike prior cycles' "promised but not landed" sanctions, this was confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. Continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: in every prior cycle, the US and Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the joint statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile-wide joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were disclosed; a separate IRGC spokesman claim (Aug 26) of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal is single-source and unconfirmed by the US or Oman. UKMTO) — both comparable in severity to the already-established pattern.
- **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28** (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iran's internationally-recognized traffic-separation-scheme shipping lanes; ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for not complying; ~100,000 tons of goods have been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed. Read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a fresh shock.
- **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead** (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the reported 15-19 range; a slight negative confirmation, not a new shock.
- **NEW — Trump declared the Strait "demined" Aug 25** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack on the Strait.

- **NEW — the first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23** (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 28) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42). Still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war baseline, but a
- **NEW — Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further; press explicitly frames this as "war premium unwinding" on the Hormuz progress.
- **NEW — no new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29** (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the strike event); the flip line remains unfired.
- **NEW — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found** — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike.
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith): the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents and the single-source IRGC revenue-sharing claim was also first flagged there as not-used. All re-verified fresh this cycle.

Carried forward from the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23 — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Casualty toll (as of Aug 22): real, but a range, not a point figure.** That cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" (19 seafarers + 1 port worker); a mid-July gCaptain snapshot said "at least 15"; IMO's own "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (fetched directly) shows 19 seafarer fatalities across 68 incidents; aggregate the broader Middle East (possibly including a separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike that killed 6, per Al Jazeera), not the Hormuz campaign cleanly. Honest range: **15-19 cumulative most Hormuz-specific trackers** — now settled higher by this cycle's IMO six-month count above (19-20).
- **No new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in that window found nothing beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline.
- **The UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing resulting indefinite trade/financial-ties suspension was initially flagged as a possible miss; on reconciliation it is the same episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera, Aug 18 strike) — a one-day cross-outlet dating variance describing one event. Iran's foreign ministry denies responsibility, calling it a possible "false flag" — genuinely disputed, both sides single-source on the event.
- **CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally was climbing incrementally as of Aug 22** (68 vessels redirected vs. ~67 shortly before) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.
- **The Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remained unsigned as of Aug 22;** the underlying 60-day US-Iran negotiation window (from the June 17 Versailles MOU) expired Aug 17 without a confirmed deal, superseded by this cycle's Oman-confirmed temporary corridor above (still not a comprehensive, US-accepted deal).
- **Brent was ~\$93-95/bbl as of Aug 20-21,** a second straight weekly gain (~6%), the highest since late July — now reversed by this cycle's two-week Brent decline above.
- **Strait of Hormuz traffic: trackers disagreed on the exact daily transit count as of Aug 22** (estimates ranged ~1% to ~20% of the pre-war ~130-170/day baseline) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.

From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a fatal strike on the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign's latest victim (CORRECTED: not the first fatality, contrary to this draft's earlier framing).** The Liberia-flagged bulk carrier (Maritime, Greece) was struck by an unknown projectile in the engine room while exiting the Strait's southern corridor, Aug 17-18; the chief engineer was killed. UKMTO's report is corroborated (Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247). No claim of responsibility yet. **Re-verified this cycle (draft2): the cumulative toll is a 15-19 range,** NEW (draft2) item above. This report's own prior cycles never surfaced or scored on that toll — flagged honestly as a research gap, not new information, and a reason this cycle is left as a draft.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22.** The Liberia-flagged tanker Amara was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17; Iran's Fars News says it's held for non-payment under Iranian regime. Still detained as of Aug 19 (Windward, Hellenic Shipping News) — a shift from attacks-only to active enforcement and detention.
- ★ **Correction to the record:** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE; the UAE framed it — UAE was hit by missile/drone barrages in April and at its Fujairah port May 4, both predating this incident. That "novel escalation vector" framing is not carried forward.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down** (GlobalSecurity Day-175 tracker) — the pause holds, a modest stabilizing factor.
- **Sanctions remain mostly rhetoric.** Treasury Secretary Bessent has repeatedly promised the "toughest sanctions in history" / to "collapse Iran's economy," with the actual package pushed to Aug 21-22. One concrete action found: an Aug 22 OFAC-adjacent designation of 10 Hezbollah-linked individuals/networks — real, but narrower than the promised Iran-economy package, which was not used.
- **Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 21)** (TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune) — up modestly on sanctions anticipation, still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait** (state media) — a mild, narrow normalizing signal amid otherwise hardening posture.
- **Mediation continues without a breakthrough;** Qatar/Oman still pushing diplomacy. Tehran "dismissed" Trump's sanctions threats Aug 21 and called the new sanctions a "declaration of war."
- **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one missile hit its waters. Iran's foreign ministry disputes involvement outright — a live, unresolved, single-source-attributed dispute, reported as such, not used alone to move P.
- **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent of attribution dispute resolves. *Re-checked this cycle (draft2): separate Aug 19-dated reporting (NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing this same missile attack and embargo was initiated by this cycle's adversarial pass — confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode, not a new one.*
- **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18,** causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry downplays "the United States began violating the memorandum shortly after its June 18 signing" — the first time either side has publicly framed the other as already in breach, rather than "very close." Trump's "time schedule" to resolve the conflict (a framing he softened, per above, on Aug 19).
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd handle this conflict's rhetoric has named Oman, previously a mediator, as a potential target. This followed Iran announcing its own agreement with Oman on shipping routes through the Strait.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM reports 68 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded (up from 62/3 previously cited). *Note: the pre-war baseline cited in the Aug 18 draft (~130/day) was independently re-checked this cycle; the more defensible baseline is 130-170/day. The discrepancy is flagged here for transparency; it does not change the direction or size of the collapse, which is stark under either baseline.*
- **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip line, move in several cycles (continued rising toward ~\$92 by Aug 19, per above).
- **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, no injuries) and one vessel was hit in the hull Aug 15 (CBS News live desk citing UKMTO, no injuries — an "unknown projectile"). Iran did not claim direct responsibility either time; UAE's Foreign Ministry called it

no casualties at the time — now compounding into the Aug 18 shipping-collapse picture above.

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent stipulations explicitly include a US withdrawal of its naval blockade, compensation for war damages, asset unfreezing, and sanctions relief; Trump separately amended his own compensation of the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Gaza" — a hardening of the same dispute, not a new demand category.
- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure — status quo.
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24, Bloomberg) — rephrased-condition picture now folded into today's compensation-dispute read.
- **★ Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government. US News/AP wire and Al Jazeera-linked reporting — a genuinely lethal incident, but in the same Houthi-proxy Red Sea theater and comparable in kind to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit and Aug 10 logged without moving P.
- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible direct impact.
- **★ Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9**, a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (six independent reports) — Saudi Arabia's energy ministry said there were no injuries and firefighters extinguished the resulting fire the same day, with no announced extended production impact.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- **★ Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com), Wall Street Journal, Times, Haaretz, Rappler, Aug 8-9): Araqchi said Iran and Oman are "very close" to an agreement on a new shipping route through the strait, but that reopening it would depend on further coordination on shipping traffic separation scheme is "no longer acceptable to Tehran."
- **★ The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting the Strait, and Oman condemned "repeated attacks on vessels" transiting the waterway without assigning blame, and described negotiations with Iran as "positive and constructive."

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- **★ Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier Gaslog Shanghai was struck and disabled carrying LNG, an explosion hit near a vessel on the Omani side (Aug 2); bulk carrier Minoan Pioneer was struck in the engine room, suffering a blackout with one crew member missing (Aug 3); two more explosions (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative incident tally now stands at 65 since the war began (Bloomberg/UANI), with Hormuz traffic described as "at a trickle."
- **★ ★ NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7**, wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns). "Iranian-backed proxies targeted Saudi Arabia, widening conflict in Middle East" (Al Jazeera, Japan Times, OIC statement corroborate).
- **★ ★ NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that raises the ceiling given Pakistan's nuclear status if Saudi Arabia is drawn further into the conflict.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping**, banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA, Fortune, NPR, Al Jazeera, Bloomberg) — Washington explicitly rejected these terms (NPR, Al Jazeera), insisting on zero tolls, permits, or approvals. The fundamental fee/sovereignty dispute is not new; the claim's specific draft terms trace to Fars News (Iranian state media, citing one parliamentarian) and should be labeled Iran-sourced, not independently verified.
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called it "duplicitous," and Iran denied direct talks had even resumed — treat the Aug 2 claim as rhetoric outpacing substance, a pattern that recurred all week (positive announcements paired with corrections within 1-2 days each time).
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- **★ Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed terms, "provided certain third parties do not obstruct the process."

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- **★ Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle was reached on the raised issues, including the map for maritime traffic entry and exit routes" — confirmed by Bloomberg (two articles), CBS, Al Jazeera (two articles), Euronews, and Military.com.
- **★ Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants a deal that would allow groups are already protesting the plan; Jerusalem Post separately reports sources saying the proposed passage deal is "not feasible for shipping industry."

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- **★ Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on the day. A Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance for Gulf/Red Sea shipping protection was reported drawing backing from 14 countries.
- **★ Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity.org reported an unknown projectile off Oman's Musandam Peninsula, its engine room damaged and the vessel disabled. These directly contradicted the Aug 1 "quiet night" framing — the pause was not complete.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first meeting — a genuine structural de-escalation-adjacent development, distinct from any single day's attack-or-lull headline.
- **★ Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall, CNN) reported the strike came after "the perimeters of a deal" were agreed over the Aug 1-2 weekend, reportedly including a full Strait of Hormuz reopening. No US strikes on Iran proper have been reported since then.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump's leadership "unbelievably duplicitous."
- **★ Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iranstitrep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was being negotiated.
- **★ Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing an agreement on a northern lane in Iranian waters, outbound via a southern lane in Omani waters, no tolls or transit fees during the interim period, and a plan to clear naval mines from the median lane within 60 days — to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization of the deal.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- **★ The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — by a "surprise attack," all intercepted by US/Jordanian defenses, **zero US casualties**. This came after a genuine 2-3 day pause in CENTCOM strikes (Jul 25-27) and on the same day Trump was

- talks with Netanyahu at the White House — both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them" — explicitly frames this as "US renews strikes on Iran as widening war pulls in more countries."
 - ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29)**, CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Wasit, and Diyala — **20 killed, 32 wounded** (Al Jazeera, CBS News, Foreign Policy, 5+ outlets). Iraq's government called it a "flagrant violation of sovereignty." This is Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors" were also killed is single-source (unnamed Iraqi militia officials) — flagged, not used.
 - ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel). A militant group has claimed responsibility; Houthis explicitly deny involvement — attribution remains unresolved.
 - **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the start of a new war (Fortune). A previously-circulated "\$87.53" figure could not be corroborated and is dropped from this report.
 - **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — directly denies claims of productive talks. A regional 10-day ceasefire proposal (Qatar/Egypt/Oman/Pakistan) remains on the table, unaccepted; Iran separately rejected an Oman joint-Hormuz-management proposal, controlling its own lane.
 - **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one 68-32 (all Dems) remains stalled.
 - ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced report (from a Massie on record) over whether the reversion dodges the 90-day War Powers clock. This is the same dispute already logged last cycle — one daily touch this week re-cited the Jul 24 CNBC article.
 - **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC, US Navy, and others claim it is closed."
 - **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~**Aug 16** remains intact and un-triggered.
 - **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
 - **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
 - **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a **~\$98,225 intraday low**, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't crossed the threshold grounds — BTC closed at **\$64,706** on Jul 30, even as the conflict spread to two new countries this week.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia-Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a **~\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended **~+25-28% week** (~+38% by late March). June 2025 rhymed: ~\$98k dip, fully recovered within a week.

The Aug 30-31 direct US-Iran exchange has now escalated sharply further: a ~50x-larger US strike wave, the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers, and a four-country Iranian retaliation (including a confirmed strike on an Iranian oil tanker). This resets the clock much harder on the upside case this pillar had been building since Aug 25 (Oman's own government confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor). That corridor claim is still untrampled, but a fresh, much-larger strike-and-retaliation cycle makes it considerably harder to argue the war is winding down at all right now. BTC traded at **\$76,581.44** on Sept 2, down from a peak of ~\$80k on Aug 28, a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own evidence. That's logged as an honesty check for the reader (see The Claim), not treated as pillar-scoring evidence. The war's facts, not the market's reaction to them. The upside case is unchanged in shape: a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept, signed and holding a full claim to the Strait of Hormuz, an attack, fatality, or seizure, would shift the prize from "temporary corridor" to "a full corridor reopens and the risk premium unwinds for real." That's now considerably further away than it was earlier. If the Prize doesn't feed the math, it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The cut may still be too small, even at 1/9/27/47/74.** Nearly 100 targets, the war's first direct tanker strikes, and a four-country simultaneous retaliation is a genuinely different order of magnitude than what has cut against before — a stricter reader could argue the front-end windows (1mo, now at P=1, barely above the floor) understate just how close this now sits to the worst-case scenario this pillar has, and that keeping the cut "under 8 points per window" mechanically, out of habit from smaller prior incidents, is itself a mistake when the underlying event is this much larger.
- **Leaving it as a draft may itself be too cautious.** The independently-confirmed facts alone — CENTCOM's own ~100-target count, the first-ever tanker strikes, the four-country retaliation, the escalation threats — are multi-sourced and sufficient on their own to justify this cut without leaning on the wedding-strike claim at all; a reader could argue this pillar is using the single-source claim to call the non-disputed facts already support, rather than a genuine evidentiary gap.
- **The cut may be too small.** This report explicitly pre-declared "a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" as the line that breaks the dip-buy thesis — and calibrated the actual cut to a 28's Jordan strike) rather than to the fact that this event fired a standing, pre-committed warning line. A stricter reader could argue firing your own flip line warrants a materially larger cut than this precisely because the report itself said in advance this class of event was different in kind, not just degree.
- **The cut may be too large.** One resumed-strike night after ~28-30 clean nights is, so far, a single interdiction event (stopping a mine-laying attempt) rather than evidence of a full campaign or escalation. Precedent this cut is sized against was itself followed by further escalation, but it's equally possible this is a contained, one-off enforcement action that doesn't repeat. If no further strikes follow, the cut may prove to have moved faster than the evidence ultimately warranted.
- **The Oman corridor confirmation (Aug 25) is not retracted.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry still has not walked back its Aug 25 joint statement — the first time both parties on the "deal" side have done so in this entire crisis. A fresh strike exchange doesn't erase that structural fact, and a reader could argue the 1yr/3yr windows are being cut too by association with a fundamentally 1mo/3mo-scale event.
- **The Aug 24 sanctions package is arguably a bigger structural story than this week's kinetic exchange.** It was the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets as a target. The chain addresses — a genuinely new, crypto-specific risk category this pillar has never faced before, and one that doesn't fade if the current strike cycle cools.
- **No confirmed US casualty, still.** The single hardest-edged clause of this pillar's own flip line — a confirmed new US combat death — remains unfired even after this week's exchange; a reader could stay contingent on that line specifically rather than firing on the strikes-resumed clause alone.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a fresh direct strike exchange is obviously less durable a shock than any of the prior escalations that triggered cuts of similar or larger size.

The Triggers

*Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-leveled August 22, 2026, refreshed August 29; **this pillar's own downside flip line FIRED August 30** (see the flip-line box below) — a resumption of direct US strikes via on-record CENTCOM statements and 20+ independent outlets; escalation continued sharply Sept 1-2 — a materially larger strike wave and a four-country retaliation; the Sept 5 tanker strike is CENTCOM-CONFIRMED and revealed by 5+ independent outlets; the Sept 6 US Navy warship strike is CENTCOM-confirmed and revealed by 5+ independent outlets; the Sept 7 US Navy warship strike is CENTCOM-confirmed and revealed by 5+ independent outlets; attack on 2 US Navy warships; Iran's SNSC secretary announces intent to declare a restricted zone beyond Hormuz into the Persian Gulf, not yet executed; CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8, and Brent crosses \$100 intraday; the IRGC retaliates for that strike by hitting Jordan's Al Azraq air base Sept 9, and Houthi forces seize the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10 closing in on Bab el-Mandeb. **As of Sept 11 a SECOND, distinct flip-line clause has now moved above \$100" clause, on a third consecutive session above \$100 including a close above \$107 on Sept 10** (top row).*

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
FIRED Sept 10-11 — a flip-line clause, CONFIRMED via 4+ independent market sources	"Sustained Brent close above \$100" — Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 (above \$108 intraday), its highest since May 19; WTI closed above \$102 for the first time since May; Brent still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, ~9% higher on the week (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500). Three consecutive sessions above \$100. <i>Correction:</i> the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday's level — an intraday read, not the close	This clause FIRES. It is the second distinct clause of this pillar (the first was the Aug 30 resumption-of-direct-US-strikes clause) — the driving force behind the Sept 10-11 escalation (6mo 22→20, 12mo 42→40, 36mo 72→71). Friday's ~3% gain in Brent is a direct result of the IEA's 2.5 mb/d demand-contraction forecast are logged
Fired Sept 9, fuller reporting landed Sept 10-11, CONFIRMED via 4 independent outlets (Reuters wire)	Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began; at least one seafarer killed, one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)	A merchant seafarer is NOT a US service member — the clause does NOT fire; existing theater, so no widening clause either
Fired Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM/Jordan's own military statement plus multi-outlet reporting	IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base — Jordan's armed forces say 18 were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement)	Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31) — does NOT fire a new-state clause; both sides confirm no casualties, so the clause does not fire either — contributes to this cycle's modest cut
Fired Sept 10, CONFIRMED via 5+ independent outlets — chokepoint NOT yet closed	Iran-aligned Houthi forces seize the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND global shipping chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail)	Same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already priced, not a new-state clause; strait closure or interdiction has actually been confirmed (CENTCOM confirmed an executed blockade) — does NOT independently fire a flip-line clause; cycle's modest cut
Second straight session, logged Sept 10 — SUPERSEDED by the Sept 10-11 firing above	Brent crude trades near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session — above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; the Sept 10 cycle logged ~\$101.25 as Thursday's level, which proved to be an intraday read (Thursday closed above \$107)	At the time, judged short of a clean multi-session sustained close — watching — the very next cycle it fired. Kept here for the a
Crossed intraday Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CNBC and ABC News — NOT a sustained close	Brent crude tops \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24 , trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil-supply worries (CNBC "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries," ABC News)	The closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but a single session — NOT this pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" threshold — does NOT fire a flip-line clause; contributes to this cycle's modest cut and is flagged
Fired Sept 8, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship," centcom.mil; NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org corroborating)	Both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed, no US casualty clause remains unfired; Gulf of Oman and Kharg Island are not new-state; the widening-to-a-new-state clause does not fire either — contributing to this cycle's modest cut
Announced Sept 6-7, on-record, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets — NOT yet executed	Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf "in the coming days," with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately says an Iran-Oman corridor agreement will be signed "in the coming days" (Press TV, Tehran Times, Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, Newsbytes, WFLA, GlobalSecurity.org)	A genuine new escalatory signal — a declared intent to sail into an expanded zone — but a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed — announced" per Al Jazeera); does NOT independently fire a flip-line clause; contributes to this cycle's modest cut
Fired Sept 5, CONFIRMED Sept 6 via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5 — M/T Downy (disabled, Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (disabled, Jask), M/T Kylo (destroyed, Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (a carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of which evaded; no US personnel harmed (centcom.mil; Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC corroborating)	Resolves the Sept 5 row this pillar previously withheld pending the sufficiency bar. Reveals a direct IRGC attack on US Navy warships — a single-tanker interdiction previously known, but does NOT fire a flip-line clause (no confirmed US casualty, no new state, Brent short of \$100); cycle's modest cut
Claimed Sept 6, single-source (IRGC) — NOT independently used to move P	Iran's IRGC claims further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels, and a strike on a US naval drone entering the Strait of Hormuz (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews)	Iran's own claim only, not yet US-confirmed — per the sufficiency rule; WATCH NEXT CYCLE for US confirmation or denial
Fired Sept 3, CONFIRMED — repeat targets, widening clause did NOT fire	Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night of launches followed	Both targets are REPEATS (Kuwait struck Sept 2, UAE struck Sept 1) — does NOT independently fire the widening-to-a-new-state clause
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED via 9 independent outlets	CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, anti-ship cruise-missile/drone launchers — roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak strike (Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI)	The already-fired (Aug 30) "resumption of direct US strikes" clause — and escalating sharply in scale — the load-bearing driver of the escalation
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED, novel	For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms) under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy	A genuinely novel escalation vector beyond anything this pillar has seen — contributes to the sharp cut, flagged as part of why this pillar is so volatile
Reported Sept 1-2, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — NOT independently used to move P	A US strike on Kuhestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party — Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. a 4-year-old), 60+ injured; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it	The claim itself does not move P per the sufficiency rule (single-source, no multi-sourcing) — reported as context for the four other events
Fired Sept 2, CONFIRMED via multi-source reporting — widening clause did NOT fire	IRGC coordinated ballistic-missile/drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — most projectiles intercepted, no confirmed new US combat death	All four are REPEAT targets — does NOT independently fire a new-state clause, but the sheer scale/coordination contributes to the widening
Fired Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMT0 plus multi-source reporting	A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm northeast of Khasab, Oman (port side, engine room, ballast tank), no casualties — follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25)	Comparable in kind to the established tanker-attack pattern — elevated window — contributes to the Sept 1 cut alongside the already-fired (Aug 30) clause; NOT independently fire a fresh flip-line clause
Claimed Aug 31, DISPUTED target / CONFIRMED incursion	Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; UAE MoD DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING it intercepted an Iranian drone over its territorial waters	Target claim NOT confirmed (UAE denies) — does NOT fire a new-state clause on its own; the confirmed drone incursion itself is a repeat

		the repeat-target Jordan pattern, contributing to the cut w flip-line bar
Fired Aug 31, on-record — not a de-escalation signal	President Trump said on-record he is still weighing further strikes on Iran , calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo)	Confirms no near-term de-escalation is signaled from the does not independently fire a flip-line clause
Fired Aug 30, CONFIRMED — FLIP LINE TRIGGERED	Resumption of direct US strikes on Iranian territory: CENTCOM struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island after observing prep to fire sea mines into the Strait — first US strike on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak; corroborated by 20+ outlets plus on-record CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins	Fires this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line as 1mo/3mo hardest (14→9, 22→17), held under 8 points per
Fired Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED (Iran-claimed damage NOT independently confirmed)	IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — Jordan's military intercepted 8 missiles; Iran claims "heavy damage," unconfirmed by US/Jordan beyond interception; no confirmed US casualty	Jordan is a repeat, not a "further new," state (struck Jul 28) widening-to-a-new-state clause; folded into the same from same escalation cycle
Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations; FIRST TIME digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; corroborated by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts; continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation	Real, primary-confirmed, directly crypto-relevant escalation negative this pillar has logged in weeks; offsets, but does n corridor confirmation below
Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), joint mine-clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary," no fee terms disclosed; Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance	Genuine upgrade — first time Oman itself, not just Iran, ha offsets, but does not by itself outweigh, the sanctions esca upside flip line (not US-accepted, didn't survive a clean we
Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29	Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents: Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties (UKMTO); Aug 27, fire onboard, extinguished same-day, crew safe (UKMTO). Neither incident's attribution confirmed by any party.	Comparable in severity to the already-priced pattern (disa — held flat, no P move, consistent with this pillar's treatme prior cycles
Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable	Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined" and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force surveillance (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News, multiple corroborating) — the Aug 27 tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability	Real, primary-sourced, but the Aug 27 attack shows the un changed — no P move
Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29	CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing: Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire)	Continuation/intensification of an existing posture — no P
Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-primary, corroborated by 4 outlets	Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range	Slight negative confirmation, not a new shock — no additi priced
Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)	First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29→42) — still ~10-15% of the pre-war baseline	Genuine first uptick, but far too small relative to baseline t logged, no P move on its own
Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29	IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters (Sepah News, Iranian state military source; via Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal) — but Oman's own Foreign Ministry did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with no mention of fees, and the IRGC's own spokesman said the US is "obstructing this process"	Single-source (Iranian state military), unconfirmed by the o not the US-accepted durable deal this pillar's flip line requ
Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker	28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran	Continuation of the Aug 1 stand-down — no P move
Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event	No new confirmed US combat death. One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing total, not new	Flip line remains unfired
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign: bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed	NOT the campaign's first fatality as this draft originally clai refresh, second adversarial pass) re-checked the toll directl "at least 15," IMO's own tracker 19 (broader Middle East sc by the most Hormuz-specific trackers), not a clean "18th." draft, alongside the full-weekly-refresh exclusion
Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22: tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime	Shift from harassment/attacks to active enforcement and o 22 re-rate
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false flag"	CORRECTED Aug 22 draft: NOT the first direct attack on th it). RECONCILED by draft2: separate Aug 19-dated reportin EgyptToday) initially flagged as a possible second incident
Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran	Dated, corroborated response independent of the missile- to the Aug 20 re-rate; re-confirmed as the same event by o
Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed	Held against the "very close" framing — no re-rate up unt new signature reported through Aug 22
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22	None found beyond the Aug 22 draft baseline — evidence fresh shock, this cycle
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened Aug 19)	Drove part of the Aug 20 re-rate; independently re-verified

Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait	New third-party threat — contributed to the re-rate; indepe
Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Facts)	Sharpest shipping deterioration logged yet — contributed verified this cycle
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait , engine damage, one crew injury	First reported crew injury from a Strait incident in several c picture
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim	Comparable in kind to the Aug 8-13 pattern on its own — 18-20 picture
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill) — Brent eases to ~\$87-90 as traffic stays low	Hardening of an existing dispute, not new — held flat, no P
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed	Comparable to the Aug 8-9 incidents — held flat, no P mo
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day	Comparable to the Aug 8 ADNOC tanker hit — held flat, n
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand ; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns "repeated attacks"	Consistent with the Aug 8 baseline — held flat, no P move
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO tally now 65 incidents since the war began	Drove the Aug 8 1mo/3mo cut — already IN the committe
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia , wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state	Contributed to the Aug 8 cut — already IN the committed
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full week without a new tanker attack	Resolved, signed, and durable = re-rate up meaningfully; t growing, or attacks continue = re-rate down further
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact	A genuine de-escalation-adjacent structural development, given Pakistan's nuclear status
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US-Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending	De-escalation confirmed — re-rate up across windows

The flip line, re-leveled — TRIGGERED Aug 30, and as of Sept 11 a SECOND distinct clause (sustained Brent close above \$100) has now ALSO fired: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct conflict widening to a further new state with *confirmed* (not disputed) attribution, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. **As of Aug 30, the "resumption of direct US strikes"** CENTCOM struck Larak Island, the first acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29. **As of Sept 11, the "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause has fired too** — three consecutive sessions above \$107 on Sept 10, its highest since May 19. Two of the four clauses are now live; the remaining two (a confirmed new US combat death, a widening to a further new state with confirmed attribution) are not. **As of Sept 11, the "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause has fired again at vastly greater scale** — CENTCOM confirms nearly 100 targets struck (~50x Aug 30) plus the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers — but none of the OTHER three clauses fired. The "confirmed new US combat death" clause remains unfired (no confirmed US casualty found as of this run); the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause did NOT fire despite Iran's Sept 2 retaliation hitting four oil tankers in the Persian Gulf (Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — every one of the four is a REPEAT target already struck earlier in this war, so "further new state with confirmed attribution" is not met; Brent rose ~5% (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6, still short of the \$100 close. The evidence is nonetheless the largest single-cycle escalation since the flip line itself fired, which is why P moved sharply down that cycle. **UPDATE, Sept 6:** CENTCOM has now confirmed the Sept 5 tankers were hit — a 3-tanker retaliation for an IRGC ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships — and Sept 6 brings further single-source IRGC claims of additional strikes. Neither independently re-fires any of the three unfired clauses, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100 — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved >2 points) and, unlike the Sept 2 cycle, is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority, no call-band flip). **The equivalent upside flip: a signed Hormuz agreement the US actually accepts that holds past a full week without a new shipping attack, fatality, or seizure.** Oman's own government rejected the offer, but the confirmed direct US-Iran naval exchange makes a durable, US-accepted deal considerably further away, not closer. Watch next cycle for: whether Sept 6's IRGC claims are independently confirmed, whether the threatened "much larger"/"significantly larger" response actually materializes, a confirmed US combat death, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 — any of which would re-rate the flip line clause and likely warrant a larger cut. **UPDATE, Sept 8:** Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning a genuine new escalatory signal, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets, but explicitly not yet executed (no boundaries announced, no confirmed incident tied to it). This does not independently re-fire any of the three unfired clauses, no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, still short of \$100 — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) in retaliation for a second IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship — a repeat pattern, not a widening to a further new state, confirmed US casualty, so neither of those clauses fires. Brent crosses \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24 (~\$100.44) — the closest this cycle has come to the "sustained Brent >\$100" clause, but an intraday sustained close, so that clause does not fire either. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. Watch next cycle for: whether Brent sustains a close above \$100 (it is now closer to that threshold than at any prior point in this war), whether the restricted zone is actually declared and enforced, whether the Iran-Oman corridor does not fire, whether a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state. **UPDATE, Sept 10:** the IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 tanker strike by firing 20 missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq base — Jordan is a repeat target and both the US and Iran have neither clause fires. Houthi forces seize the Yemeni port of Mocha, closing in on Bab el-Mandeb — a second chokepoint, but the same actor/theater already priced, and no strait closure has actually been confirmed either. Brent now trades above \$100 for a second straight session — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross and the closest this cycle has come to the "sustained Brent >\$100" clause, but still short of a clean sustained close. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. Watch next cycle for: whether Brent sustains a third session (the closest this war has come to a sustained close), whether the Houthis actually execute a blockade or closure at Bab el-Mandeb, whether the restricted zone beyond Hormuz is actually declared, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state.

My Decision

COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 11, 2026 (2026-09-11_draft) · LIGHT DAILY CATCH-UP

P (2026-09-11_draft): 1 / 4 / 20 / 40 / 71 · Prior committed P (2026-09-10_draft, light daily catch-up, auto-stamped): 1 / 5 / 22 / 42 / 72 · My W Impact: 8 (uniform) · Master (equal-weight) signals this cycle: 1mo -1.62 · 3mo -1.29 · 6mo -0.01 · 1yr +1.75 · 3yr +2.94 · THE FINAL NUMBER (Neutral) / +0.90 horizon-weighted (Mild Bull) — no call-band flip vs. the last stamped set

Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft), this version: the load-bearing development is that this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause has FIRED. Brent ended 6% above \$107, after trading above \$108 intraday — its highest in nearly four months, since May 19 — with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, Trading Economics, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back. That is three consecutive sessions above \$100, two of them decisively so; the two prior cycles called this a near-miss and explicitly flagged it for watching, and the honest reading now is that it fired. *Correction to the prior cycle:* the Sept 10 run logged ~\$101.25 as the intraday read, not the close. Second, fuller reporting landed on the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire; no further new state was struck, and not fire either. Logged but not used to move P: a single compilation putting Hormuz throughput at 7 transits Sept 9 vs a Kpler 10-day average of 10-13/day. Logged as counterweight: Friday's give-back is not the IEA's 2.5 mb/d demand-contraction forecast. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/4/20/40/71** — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 5→4, 6mo 22→20, 12mo 42→40, 36mo 72→71. **Auto-stamp decision:** this research access was full (WebSearch/WebFetch working, local quant refresh ran), and verification passed clean — and under the runbook's widened delegated authority, neither the size of a move nor the call band is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. **This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** CLARITY Act and Tokenization held flat on independent re-check; Fed & after the August CPI print landed mid-cycle with core a tenth cooler than consensus — see those reports.

Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft), prior cycle: two new dated facts since the Sept 9 baseline. (1) CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base — Jordan's armed forces state 18 were intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, corroborated statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck previously Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does NOT fire; CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties, so the confirmed-US-casualty-KIA count remains 18, unchanged since Sept 4 per GlobalSecurity's own tracker — a separate low-quality aggregator claiming a fresh KIA figure was checked and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM statement). (2) Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a SECOND global shipping chokepoint distinct from independent outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), clearing the sufficiency bar. This is the same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already further new state), and no strait closure or shipping interdiction has actually been confirmed yet — outlets describe Houthis as "closing in on" and "threatening" control, not as having executed a blockade or fired a flip-line clause either. Separately, Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: Brent above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; Trading Economics: Brent 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's single-day intraday cross, but still short of a clean multi-session "sustained" call by this pillar's own conservative standard; flagged as the closest this cycle has come, and not a cycle, but does not independently fire that clause. Net: a repeat-pattern regional strike plus a new-but-same-actor Yemen/Red Sea territorial escalation, both intensifying the trend already priced without credit. Cut applied to 3mo/6mo/12mo only (-1 point each: 6→5, 23→22, 43→42); 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room) and 36mo held flat at 72 (a repeat regional strike and a same-theater territorial shift thesis). No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral→Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull→Mild Bull per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority this set is **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**)

Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship," centcom.mil) confirms US Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles on Sept 8 days. Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own release — clears the sufficiency bar. CENTCOM confirms both Iranian warships and no US personnel were harmed — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired — and Gulf of Oman/Kharg Island are both existing theater, so the widening-to-a-new-state clause does not fire, not a fresh category of event. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday today (Sept 9) for the first time since July 24 — confirmed by CNBC ("Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat escalates," and ABC News, trading ~\$100.44, +2.57% — a genuine escalation data point and the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" threshold, independently fire that clause either. Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains in the same not-yet-executed state as the Sept 8 baseline logged it — coverage today still describes boundaries but not re-scored a second time. This is a continuation and intensification of the same escalation trend the Sept 6/8 cycles already priced, not a fresh flip-line event. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at 72, 3mo 24→23, 12mo 44→43, 36mo 73→72.** No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft), prior cycle: Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record (Iranian state TV, carried by Press TV and Tehran Times), Sept 6-7, that Iran's "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf "in the coming days," with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list; he separately said an Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed. Corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media — clears the sufficiency bar. CENTCOM's Sept 8 escalation signal but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced," and no zone has been confirmed yet. This cycle's research cutoff. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS US KIA remains 18 (unchanged since Sept 4), no widening to a further new state, and Brent closed ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 8, still short of \$100. GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) blockade count of 92 redirected / 3 disabled / 2 boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced trend, not scored as a new state. An Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 8→7, 6mo 25→24, 12mo 45→44, 36mo held at 73.** No window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had explicitly withheld from public confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known. US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers on Sept 5 — M/T Downy (permanently disabled off Kharg Island), M/T Stark 1 (permanently disabled off Kharg Island), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer); both ships evaded, no casualties, no harm. Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets in addition to CENTCOM's own release — this clears the sufficiency bar the Sept 5 baseline explicitly with unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels rather than a quiet single-tanker interdiction. Separately, Sept 6 (today) brings further IRGC claims — three more tankers, three "US-linked" vessels, and a US Navy warship (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) — which are Iran's own claims only, not yet US-confirmed, and are NOT used to move P; watch next cycle. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS US KIA remains 18 (unchanged since Sept 4), Kharg Island/Jask/Gulf of Oman are all existing theater (not a new state), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 (markets closed Saturday) — still short of \$100. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 9→8, 6mo 27→25, 12mo 47→45, 36mo 74→73.** No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar (CENTCOM's own release), and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral, checked both against the prior committed baseline and against an isolated same-BTC-price comparison) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Sept 3-5 re-check, held flat: Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night targets are REPEATS (Kuwait struck Sept 2, UAE struck earlier this war), so the widening-to-a-new-state clause still does not fire. Brent held roughly flat (~\$95.2-95.75 Sept 4), still short of \$100. Two developments: (1) Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts who concluded the Sept 1 Kuhestan wedding-party strike was likely a direct hit by a US munition (JSOW-type glide-bomb), and the US upgraded the casualty claim's sourcing from single-narrative to independently corroborated by a primary Western wire service, but the US has still not accepted responsibility (VP Vance: "extremely skeptical of the investigation), and the confirmation resolves attribution of an ALREADY-PRICED Sept 1-2 event rather than describing new escalation, so it does not independently move P; (2) Sept 5 (today, developing): Iran's (Fars) reported four missiles struck an Iranian oil tanker near Kharg Island, Iran's primary oil-export terminal — no CENTCOM or independent Western multi-source confirmation as of this research pass, so per the single-narrative claim is NOT used to move P. WATCH NEXT CYCLE: if independently confirmed, this would be a materially new escalation vector (a direct hit on Iran's core oil-export infrastructure, distinct from strikes). Also noted: Iran reportedly warned the US that an Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "large-scale attack" on Israel; the IDF took the ridge Sept 3, but no such attack has been confirmed, live pending trigger, not a fired one. **P HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. CORRECTION:** this cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 5, 2026," but config/scores.json's status field was not set to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here and not corrected retroactively.

Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version: independently re-verified via WebSearch. The Sept 5 tanker report has firmed up considerably since the daily touch a few hours earlier: the Iranian-flagged NITC tanker STARK 1, struck by four missiles ~6 nautical miles off Kharg Island per Tasnim (Iranian state media); separately, Iran International — a London-based Persian broadcaster editorialized an adversarial to Tehran — obtained video of three US radio warnings ordering the crew to abandon ship before the strike, corroborating that a strike and warnings occurred. However, AP's own wire story on Sept 5 accuses the US of targeting a tanker — treating it as an accusation, not a confirmed fact — and US Central Command had not issued any statement confirming or denying this specific strike as of this research pass. CENTCOM's on-the-record July 14-15 naval-blockade doctrine, under which the Curacao-flagged M/T Belma was disabled via Hellfire-into-smokestack after ignoring warnings — that precedent is already priced into the rule, the identity of the striking party still needs either a primary confirmation (CENTCOM/Pentagon on the record) or independent-of-the-accusing-party corroboration of that specific fact; Iran International's warnings were issued and a strike occurred, but does not independently confirm US authorship versus Iran's own narrative — so this is NOT used to move P this cycle, consistent with the daily touch's conclusion. WATCH NEXT CYCLE for CENTCOM confirmation or denial. None of the pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week regardless: no confirmed new US combat death (standing count remains 18 per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority), no widening to a further new state (Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE strikes were both repeat targets), and Brent held ~\$95-96/bbl Sept 3-4 — up roughly 9% w/w on the broader escalation but still short of the \$100 sustainment level.

FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of move size (here, zero) — left for manual review, and COMMITTED 2026.

This is a light daily catch-up against the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped) — but it turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since the flip line itself fired Aug 30. **The load-bearing new fact materially Sept 1-2.** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on tankers under a newly reported “tanker for tanker” policy. A US strike on Kuhestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party (Hormozgan governor’s office: 4 of at least 5 dead including a 4-year-old, 60+ neither confirmed nor denied it, and this claim is explicitly flagged single-narrative-sourced at the core fact level, so it is NOT itself used to move P. It is reported as context for Iran’s response: coordinated strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — all repeat targets, so the widening-to-a-new-state flip-line clause does not fire. Multi-source corroborated: Axios, Al Jazeera, Yahoo, CBS News, RFE/RL.

P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY: 1mo 7→1, 3mo 15→9, 6mo 32→27, 12mo 50→47, 36mo 75→74. Every window moved under 8 points, but this is the largest front-loaded cut since the Aug 30-31 flip-line fact independently re-fires a fresh flip-line clause (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100), but the already-fired “resumption of direct US strikes on Iran” moved sharply in scale, which is what’s driving the size of this move.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the four-country retaliation hit repeat targets, most projectiles were intercepted, and no US casualty is confirmed. But the trajectory since Aug 30 is not far away from, a sustained and escalating exchange, and both sides are on-record threatening still-larger responses. A confirmed new US combat death, a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or Brent short of \$100 would each independently warrant a further, larger cut.

Why this was originally left as a draft Sept 2, pending manual review: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of that day’s four-country retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced across Western outlets, so confidence in that cycle’s sizing was lower than for a cleanly multi-sourced primary event, and this pillar’s own research chose not to self-approve a cut resting partly on nearly 100 targets and the war’s first-ever direct tanker strikes, versus two rocket/mine-launchers on Aug 30 — was a genuinely novel escalation this pillar’s prior single-incident sizing precedents didn’t clear. (2) on-record threatening much larger responses ahead (“significantly larger” from Trump, “many times greater” from an Iranian military source), raising the cost of a miscalibrated cut. It also independently flipped the NUMBER’s equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus the last stamped set — under the rules in force that day, this alone disqualified the set from delegated daily auto-stamp.

September 3, 2026 update: Alex reviewed this cycle’s research (delivered as PDFs Sept 2) and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy in CLAUDE.md: a call-band flip and the size of a move are now on their own — the only remaining holds are a genuine research-capability gap that cycle, or an unresolved verification inconsistency. This cycle had neither: the research was multi-sourced, and the single-narrative-sourced fact was correctly kept out of the P move under the sufficiency rule. Nothing about the underlying facts, sourcing, or the sizing of the cut changed — only the stamping threshold did. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED**

Historical note: the paragraph above was the Sept 2 cycle’s original manual-review flag, superseded by the Sept 3 auto-stamp policy widening and, again, by this cycle’s own auto-stamp. Left here for the audit trail. Override any P and re-stamp any cycle if reviewed — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Light daily catch-up, September 11, 2026 (score set 2026-09-11_draft) — checking for changes since the Sept 10 committed baseline (2026-09-10_draft, light daily catch-up, auto-stamped).

- ★ **★ NEW — the “sustained Brent close above \$100” flip-line clause FIRED.** Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 (above \$108 intraday), its highest since May 19; WTI up 4% since May; Brent still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, ~9% higher on the week (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500). Third consecutive session above \$100. Cycle’s ~\$101.25 “Thursday” figure was an intraday read, not that day’s close.
- ★ **★ NEW — fuller reporting of Iran’s Sept 9 shipping wave: 10 vessels attacked near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war; at least one sailor killed.** (via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). Not a US service member — the US-casualty clause does not fire.
- **Logged, not scored:** Hormuz throughput at 7 transits Sept 9 vs a Kpler 10-day average of 10-13/day (single-source compilation). **Counterweight, logged:** Friday’s ~3% Brent give-back on H. 2.5 mb/d 2026 demand-contraction forecast.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. One flip-line clause fired (sustained close above \$100), but US casualty and widening clauses did not. Under the widened delegated authority the size of the move is not a reason to withhold the stamp — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** to baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan’s Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, retaliating for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** Jordan’s air base fired 2 interceptors, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan’s own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target — the widening clause does not fire. Side — the US-casualty clause does not fire either.
- ★ **★ NEW — Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait,** a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (via Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail). Same actor/theater already priced; no strait closure actually confirmed.
- **★ NEW — Brent crude trades near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session** (above \$101 Sept 9, ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9’s intraday cross, the closest this cycle to a sustained close.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independently fired (Brent above \$100 but not yet a sustained close). No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharak).** Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org). US Navy press release (“US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship”). Both Iranian missile attempts evaded, no US personnel harmed.
- **Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24,** trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC, ABC News) — the closest that cycle had to an intraday cross, not a sustained close.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new “restricted zone” from the US Navy’s blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning Iranian ships.** Corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media (Press TV, Tehran Times).
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera’s own Sept 7 explainer says boundaries have yet to be announced; no zone has actually been declared. A parallel claim of an imminent strike is likewise not yet done.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independently fired (Brent above \$100 but not yet a sustained close). No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, committed_by “Alex (auto-stamped)”.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM’s own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld: THREE Iranian tankers struck (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) in retaliation for an Iranian attack on US Navy warships.** Corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other outlets. Both US ships evaded, no American personnel harmed.

- ★ **Sept 6's single-source IRGC claims of further strikes on 3 more tankers, 3 "US-linked" vessels, and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remained US-unconfirmed — not u
- ★ **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** (from 1/9/27/47/74) — no window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-** authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05_draft2, committed by Alex), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Kuwait and UAE, both REPEAT targets.** A US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit; the widening-to-a-new-state clause
- ★ ★ **NEW — Sept 5: the Iranian-flagged NITC tanker STARK 1 reportedly hit by four missiles ~6nm off Kharg Island.** Iran's Tasnim (state media) makes the claim; Iran International (indep obtained video of US radio warnings preceding the strike; AP's own wire story is headlined "Iran accuses the US of targeting a tanker" (an accusation, not a confirmed fact); CENTCOM has not to move P per the sufficiency rule — WATCH NEXT CYCLE.
- ★ **Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts corroborating the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding-strike casualty claim as likely a direct US-munition hit** — resolve event, not new escalation; US has not accepted responsibility. NOT used to move P.
- ★ **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74.** No flip-line clause independently fired this week (no confirmed new US combat death, no widening to a further new state, Brent short of \$100), categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy, so it went to manual review — **COMMITTED BY ALEX SEPTEMBER 5, 2026.**
- ★ **Correction:** the same-day earlier 2026-09-05_draft's commit message claimed it was auto-stamped, but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced — a bug in that session. remains 2026-09-02_draft. Flagged for Alex, not corrected retroactively.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02_draft, committed), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, ~50x the scale of the Aug 30 strike.** IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms missile/drone launchers. Multi-source: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms),** under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy.
- ★ ★ **NEW, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan.** Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it. NOT independently used to move P — reported as context for the retaliation it triggered.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait.** All four are repeat targets — does NOT independently fire the flip line clause. Most projectiles intercepted; no confirmed new US combat death.
- ★ **NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tue Sept 1 (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6; WTI ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100 flip line. Both sides now on-record threatening larger future action (Trump response"; an Iranian military source: "many times greater," per CNBC).
- ★ **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 (Sept 2)** — down from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.
- ★ **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75) — 1mo -6, 3mo -6, 6mo -5, 12mo -3, 36mo -1; front-loaded, kept under the 8-point threshold, but this since the Aug 30-31 flip-line-firing cut. Originally left as draft Sept 2 for Alex's manual review (single-narrative wedding-casualty fact, genuinely novel scale, both sides threatening larger future flip Mild Bull → Neutral); **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy so a call-band flip and move size no longer withh

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles (Oman (port side, engine room, ballast tank hit); no casualties. Follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25).
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING a cross-border drone incursion.** Iran confirmed drone detected over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iran — corroborated by CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, and Iran
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran,** calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo) — not a de-escalation signal.
- ★ **Brent continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday, multiple market-desk reports)** — second straight cycle of gains on this news thread; Jordan struck again Aug 30-31 but remained a r
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 (Sept 1)** — down from \$78,447.16 (Aug 31, Bitstamp).
- ★ **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — 1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat; no single new fact independently fired a fresh flip-line the Aug 30-31 cut's working assumption that one resumed-strike night was not yet a sustained campaign. **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority: light daily touch, no window moved unchanged vs. the last stamped set (Mild Bull → Mild Bull), sourcing well above the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson (Capt. Tim Hawkins) plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two I Larak Island after observing prep to fire sea mines into the Strait — first acknowledged US strike on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak. **Fired this pillar's own pre-declar** resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement.** King Hussein and Al-Azraq airbases targeted; Iran claims "heavy damage," unconfirmed by US/Jordan beyond interception; IRGC confirmed casualties at Larak (no precise toll); no confirmed US casualty from either event.
- ★ **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 (Aug 31)** — up from \$77,666.16 (Aug 29, Bitstamp).
- ★ **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, front-loaded, to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76) — 1mo -5, 3mo -5, 6mo -4, 12mo -3, 36mo -1, sized to a single resumed-strike-night shock. AUTO authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, held P flat, left as draft, now superseded), for continuity:

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov (sb0613, sb0614) and an OFAC recent-actions entry.** ~60 entities/individ Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five EO 13902 sectoral determinations; corroborated by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes, law-firm alerts. **For was named a sanctionable sector — 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed.** Real, primary-confirmed, crypto-specific — unlike the "promised, not landed" sanctions rhetoric this pill. Continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: every prior Iran alone; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the statement. Terms: temporary 7-mile joint navigational corridor, joint mine-clearing project, continuing talks toward a permanent corridor. St Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance. No fee terms disclosed.
- ★ **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents,** Aug 24 (off Oman, engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, crew comparable in severity to the already-priced pattern).
- ★ **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28:** Iranian sea mines cleared from the shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement l disabled; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire).
- ★ **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead** across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the prior 15-19 range.
- ★ **NEW — Trump announced Aug 25 the Strait had been demined,** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27
- ★ **NEW — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week** for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News/Lloyd's List) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week baseline.

- **NEW, FLAGGED AND NOT USED — an IRGC spokesman's Aug 26 claim of an Iran-Oman Hormuz revenue-sharing agreement** (Sepah News, Iranian state military source) is unconfirmed Ministry, and the two countries' joint statement describes only an "interim framework" with no fees — single-source, explicitly not the US-accepted deal this pillar's flip line requires.
- **Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21) — moving further from the \$100 flip line.
- **No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29;** no new US/CENTCOM strikes found (GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker, 28th consecutive clean night).
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 (Aug 29)** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 (Aug 22, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76** — the confirmed sanctions escalation and the confirmed Oman corridor upgrade roughly offset; neither independently clears the sufficiency draft, not auto-stamped (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority).

Carried forward — the abandoned Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28, draft), for audit continuity: that draft first logged the two Aug 24/27 tanker incidents, Trump's Aug 25 demining claim, and the IRGC revenue-sharing claim rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, so this Aug 29 cycle re-researched and re-verified all of it fresh (see above) rather than carry it forward on trust. Treated as not-delivered, same discipline as the Aug 17-21 gap.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22, draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23), for continuity: Background, for completeness: Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but never rendered, and an Aug 21 session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers (2 of 6 reports touched) before stopping without finishing render/selfcheck/archive/commit; the Aug 22 morning catch-up treated all four as not-delivered or parallel primary-source research passes, cutting P to 14/22/38/54/76 and delivering it as a draft. The Aug 22 full weekly refresh independently re-researched the pillar again and ran a second, dedicated adversarial pass.

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel" claim, never rendered, verified, or archived).
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — treated as not-delivered, no discipline, not trusted at face value.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign,** Aug 17-18: bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly) confirmed fatality," then corrected to "roughly the 18th such death" — a toll this report had never surfaced before.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22,** the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial re-check cycle.
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel" claim on the Aug 20 manual-review hold was retired; re-confirmed again this cycle.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (17-18), and IMO's own "Middle East Highlighted Incidents" page (19, but broader-Middle-East scoped, not clean Hormuz) — honest toll is a **15-19 range (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific)** — the morning draft's "roughly the 18th" framing, which was more precise than the sources support; corrected everywhere in this report.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describing the embargo response was initially flagged by this cycle's adversarial pass as a possible miss; confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline.
- **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, vs. 67 as of Aug 18); Oman corridor deal remains unsigned as of Aug 22; Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 20-21), a second straight weekly gain, still under the \$100 flip line.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran says no new tankers through the Strait.
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Claim), not a score decision.
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → **14** · 3mo 28 → **22** · 6mo 41 → **38** · 12mo 56 → **54** · 36mo 77 → **76** — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft; Halted at delivery (full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority); **COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026** after review. See My Decision for the full reasoning.

Sources

Retrieved & graded September 11, 2026, light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11, draft; earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources first, then news, then analysis, then commentary. This cycle's research: Rigzone (Bloomberg wire), TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, and NAI500 on Brent's close above \$107 Sept 10 and ~\$104.36 Sept 11; Reuters (via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill) on the wave; GlobalSecurity.org's Iran War Day 195 summary for the Sept 10 order of battle.

- **September 11 light daily catch-up (this cycle):** Rigzone (Bloomberg wire, Sept 10) — Brent ended Thursday up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, highest in nearly four months; WTI closed at \$80.00, up 1.5% on the day. — TradingEconomics (Sept 10-11) — Brent ~\$104.36 Friday, -3.04% on the day, -9% higher on the week; cites Hormuz diplomacy and the IEA's 2.5 mb/d 2026 demand-contraction forecast as the counterweight · Vantage Markets — corroborating Brent above \$100-102 on Hormuz strike risk · Reuters wire via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill (Sept 9) — Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), largest declared wave since 2019, at least one seafarer killed, one missing · GlobalSecurity.org, Iran War 2026 Day 195 (Sept 10) — direct fetch returned HTTP 403 this cycle, so its content is cited only as surfaced in search summaries (flagged as a degraded source)
- **September 10 light daily catch-up:** Al Jazeera (Sept 9), MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org (Iran War 2026 Day 194) — corroborating reporting on Jordan's own military statement confirming the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at an air base, 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties · The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail — corroborating reporting on the Houthi seizure of a ship, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait · CNBC — Brent above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9, first time since May · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10 · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) unchanged; a separate low-quality aggregator's claim of a fresh KIA figure checked and rejected as uncorroborated · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$77,993.99 (Sept 10) vs. \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8)
- **September 9 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship" (Sept 8, primary source): M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Derya (Kharg Island) · NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the same CENTCOM statement and the two IRGC missile attempts on a US Navy warship, both evaded · Reuters (via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill) — U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries" (Sept 9) · ABC News — corroborating Brent ~\$100.44 intraday, +2.57% · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).
- **September 8 light daily catch-up:** Press TV, Tehran Times (Iranian state media) — Mohsen Rezaei's (SNSC secretary) on-record statement, Sept 6-7, announcing intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade, sanctioning any vessel entering it, and an Iran-Oman corridor agreement "in the coming days" · Al Jazeera ("Can Iran enforce a restricted zone in the Strait of Hormuz?," Sept 7 explainer, noting boundaries not yet announced) · Reuters (via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill) — (aa.com.tr), Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the same Rezaei statement · GlobalSecurity.org — Iran War 2026 Day 192 update (Sept 7): blockade count 92 vessels redirected, 3 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 close · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$78,435.62 (Sept 7) vs. \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7).
- **September 6 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "CENTCOM Destroys 3 IRGC Oil Tankers After Iran Targets 2 U.S. Navy Warships" (Sept 5, primary source) · Al Arabiya English, Jerusalem Post, ArmyRecognition, The National — corroborating reporting on the same CENTCOM statement, ship names (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) and the IRGC ballistic-missile attack on 2 US Navy warships · Al Jazeera liveblog (Sept 5) — on 3 oil tankers and 3 US-linked ships, Sept 6) and Euronews (Sept 6, Iranian forces targeting a US naval drone) — Iran's own Sept 6 follow-on claims, not US-confirmed, NOT used to move P · standing DoD casualty records (checked directly) — 18 confirmed as of Sept 4, unchanged · TradingEconomics / multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 close (US/UK markets closed Saturday Sept 6, no new print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,646.11 (Sept 5).
- **September 3-5 re-check:** GlobalSecurity — Iran War 2026 Day 188-189 updates (Sept 3-4): Iran's second retaliatory wave hit Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE), both repeat targets; a US official confirmed the strike, Trump corrected a misstatement to reaffirm the standing US KIA count at 18 · Reuters (via Spokesman-Review, Nukta, Tribune, TBS News, unnn.ua) — four independent weapons experts' forensic analysis of images/video of the Sept 1 Kuhstak wedding strike was likely a direct hit by a US munition (JSOW-type glide-bomb fragments); VP Vance's "extremely skeptical" comment, Sept 4 · Times of Israel liveblog, Euronews, Newswire.lk — Sept 5 Iran's own report of a tanker strike near Kharg Island, unconfirmed by CENTCOM or any independent source · Critical Threats/ISW — Iran's warning that an Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "large-scale attack" on Israel, attack confirmed as of this run.
- **September 2 light daily catch-up — CENTCOM-confirmed strikes plus multi-source reporting on the retaliation:** Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI — corroborating reporting on the CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes on IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms sites, anti-ship cruise-missile/drone launchers) and the first-ever direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" deal · UPI — reporting on the Kuhstak, Hormozgan wedding-strike casualty claim (Hormozgan governor's office source; CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied it — flagged as a degraded source, per this report's own sufficiency rule) · Al Jazeera, Yahoo, CBS News, RFE/RL — corroborating reporting on Iran's IRGC Sept 2 coordinated strikes on Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait, interception rates, and the absence of deaths · CNBC — Trump's "significantly larger response" threat and an unnamed senior Iranian military source's "many times greater" quote · multiple market-desk reports — Brent ~+5% Tue Sept 1 (best session in 5 weeks) · Bitstamp — BTC \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) vs. \$78,038.78 (Sept 1).
- **September 1 light daily catch-up — UKMTO log plus multi-source reporting:** UKMTO — Senegal Prosperity incident log, Aug 31 (VLCC struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm NE of Khasab, Oman; port side, engine room hit) · CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, Iran International — corroborating reporting on the Al Minhad Air Base drone-strike claim (Iran's army) and the UAE Ministry of Defense's claim of a strike on a US Navy warship.

- tanker attacks (July 7) · CBS live — Treasury waiver revocation, CENTCOM 80+ targets, IRGC 85-site claim (July 8) · Al Jazeera — Trump "ceasefire over" quotes (July 8).
- **Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial (July 10) · Al Jazeera — mediators urge MoU compliance (July 9) · CNN live — Trump on talks / "Cease Fire is OVER", Qatari team to Tehran (July 9) · Times of Israel — July 11 talks date via Al Arabiya (single-source relay, unconfirmed) · Times of Israel liveblog — Israel-join-strikes report (July 10; single-source, unconfirmed) · Al Jazeera — Doha outcomes (July 10).
 - **The oil waiver:** CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).
 - **The prices:** Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00–76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI <\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (July 10) · near halt, war-risk 2–6% of hull value (July 9) · The New Arab — JMIC "severe" advisory · LMA — insurance availability vs safety concerns · *(Hormuz traffic magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% during strikes; throughput figures are from the unofficial straits.live tracker — single-source)* · CoinDesk — BTC steady above \$62K (July 9) · CoinDesk — BTC to ~\$64K on chips/yen, not Iran (July 10) · Fortune — BTC ~\$61.7K (July 6, pre-strikes) · liquidations (July 8).
 - **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print) · Blockchain.News — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Direct Polymarket — 13); "US invades Iran before 2027" relayed via secondary aggregators only — inconsistent snapshots ~14.5% (Jul 8) → ~15.5% (~Jul 10) → ~17% (most recent), inconsistency itself flagged. "MoU withdrawal by Jul 31" reads (Jul 10) · by Dec 31" (35.5% last verified Jul 8) are stale and not re-verified this week.